



Himalayan Institute of Technology

Department of Computer Engineering

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14 September 2026

Study NT Scholarship Assessment Panel

Department of Trade, Business and Asian Relations

Northern Territory Government, Darwin NT 0800, Australia

RE: Letter of support for Ms Sita Karki, 2026-27 Scholarship Program Round 1 (Study NT)

To the Assessment Panel,

I am Associate Professor of Computer Engineering at Himalayan Institute of Technology, and I have known Sita Karki for four years. I taught her in Data Structures and Machine Learning, I supervised her final year project, and I am the faculty adviser to the Women in Technology Society she led in 2024. I am pleased to give her my strongest support.

Academic. Sita is one of the three strongest students I have taught in 17 years. She has a GPA of 3.84 and her work shows real depth, not only high marks. Her project on crop disease detection for low bandwidth settings was technically careful, tested with 60 farmers, and won first place at the 2025 National Student Innovation Showcase. She writes clear code and clear reports, and she accepts criticism well.

Personal and leadership. Sita founded Code Pahadi, a free coding club for rural girls, without being asked and without funding. I have visited two of its classes. The students are engaged and the mentors are former students she trained. As President of the Women in Technology Society she grew membership from 40 to 125 and secured 12 internships. She is reliable, generous with her time and calm under pressure.

I have no doubt she will do well in Darwin and give back to the community there. I recommend her without reservation. Please contact me if you need more information.

Yours sincerely,

Anita Rai

Dr Anita Rai

Associate Professor and Head of Department, Computer Engineering

Himalayan Institute of Technology

Relationship: lecturer, project supervisor and faculty adviser. Length of association: 4 years (since August 2022).

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